Repository Custom Instructions for Copilot Chat

Question: A Python engineering team wants every contributor in a repository to automatically receive Copilot Chat responses that follow their internal coding standards (e.g., always use `pytest` fixtures, strict type annotations, and Google-style docstrings) without manually repeating these rules in every prompt. Which file path should they commit to the repository?

A. `.vscode/copilot-rules.yaml`

B. `.github/copilot-instructions.md` **[CORRECT ANSWER]**

C. `.github/workflows/copilot-style.yml`

D. `COPILOT_SYSTEM_PROMPT.txt` in the user's home directory

Explanation & Exam Rationale

GitHub Copilot supports repository-level custom instructions via a Markdown file placed at `.github/copilot-instructions.md`. When committed to the repository, Copilot Chat automatically appends these natural-language guidelines to user prompts as shared team context, ensuring consistent framework choices, testing conventions, and style compliance across all contributors.

Mechanism	Location / Scope	Primary Purpose
`.github/copilot-instructions.md`	Repository-wide (version-controlled)	Shared team coding conventions, preferred libraries, and formatting rules
`.github/instructions/*.instructions.md`	Path-specific (via `applyTo` glob frontmatter)	Targeted rules for specific file types (e.g., `**/*.test.ts` or SQL migrations)
VS Code `github.copilot.chat.codeGeneration.instructions`	User / Workspace `settings.json`	Personal or local IDE-specific prompt preferences

Key Exam Takeaway: Remember the exact path `.github/copilot-instructions.md` and note that custom instructions shape *Copilot Chat* behavior without modifying the underlying foundation model weights (unlike fine-tuning).